"God has abandoned me."

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Where it often comes from

In long illness, prayers can feel unanswered and God silent. Loneliness and pain make His presence hard to sense.

What Scripture teaches

"Why, O LORD, do You stand far off?" the psalmist asks. And yet: "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted." "When you pass through the waters, I will be with you." Hebrews records God's promise, "Never will I leave you, never will I forsake you" (Hebrews 13:5). Feelings of abandonment are real, and they are not the final word. Even Jesus on the cross cried out, "My God, My God, why have You forsaken Me?" (Psalm 22:1). God understands the sense of abandonment, and He has not left you.

> *"When you pass through the waters, I will be with you; and when you go through the rivers, they will not overwhelm you. When you walk through the fire, you will not be scorched; the flames will not set you ablaze"* (Isaiah 43:2).

Also see

> "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit" (Psalm 34:18).

> "Why, O LORD, do You stand far off? Why do You hide in times of trouble?" (Psalm 10:1).

> "Keep your lives free from the love of money and be content with what you have, for God has said: 'Never will I leave you, never will I forsake you.'" (Hebrews 13:5).

> "Yet I am always with You; You hold my right hand" (Psalm 73:23).

Common self-statements

- God has left me.
- He is silent because He is gone.
- I am on my own.
- He does not care.
- My prayers go nowhere.
- I feel nothing.

Common logical errors

- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing God is either felt or absent.
- Fortune telling: Predicting that God will never come near.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling alone and concluding that God is gone.
- Emotional reasoning: Calling myself abandoned.

Challenging questions

- When have I felt God near before?
- Who has shown up for me in this illness?
- What does Scripture promise about God's presence in hardship?

- What did the psalmists do with feelings of abandonment?
- How might God be present in ways I do not feel?
- What small act of trust could I take?

Truth summary

> Feeling abandoned is not the same as being abandoned. God promises to be with me through the waters. I can cry out honestly, look for His presence in people and Scripture, and trust Him.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Suffering
- Loneliness
- God, All Knowing
- Faith
- Trust

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Forgive/Forgiveness
- Divorce

Listen: Overcoming Depression

> Overcoming Depression · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 20 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Praise You in This Storm — Casting Crowns featuring Phil Wickham
Suffering and tears do not establish that God is absent or uncaring.

I Am Not Alone — Kari Jobe
God's companionship remains through darkness, weakness, and uncertainty.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "God has abandoned me"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"God has abandoned me." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ When have I felt God near before?
- ☐ Who has shown up for me in this illness?
- ☐ What does Scripture promise about God's presence in hardship?
- ☐ What did the psalmists do with feelings of abandonment?
- ☐ How might God be present in ways I do not feel?
- ☐ What small act of trust could I take?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ God is with me through the waters.
- ☐ He is near to the brokenhearted.
- ☐ He will never leave me.
- ☐ I can cry out honestly.
- ☐ Feelings are not facts.
- ☐ He holds my right hand.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Isaiah 43:2**
  "When you pass through the waters, I will be with you; and when you go through the rivers, they will not overwhelm you. When you walk through the fire, you will not be scorched; the flames will not set you ablaze."
- ☐ **Psalm 34:18**
  "The LORD is near to the brokenhearted; He saves the contrite in spirit."
- ☐ **Psalm 10:1**
  "Why, O LORD, do You stand far off? Why do You hide in times of trouble?"

A verse I found myself: _____

_____

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- ☐ Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- ☐ Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ Signs of presence: Each week, note one sign of God's presence or care.
- ☐ My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Isaiah 43:2 becomes: "Sarah can write: "I will not be abandoned; God is with me through the waters.""
- ☐ Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ Reading: The "Suffering" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ Listening: The Overcoming Depression audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

These cards support emotional and spiritual care and do not replace medical care. Follow your doctor's advice about treatment and medication, and choose steps that are safe for your body. In an emergency call 911; for thoughts of self-harm call or text 988 (U.S.).

- ☐ Cry out. Pray Psalm 13 or 22.
- ☐ Look for signs. Note kindness, provision, and peace.
- ☐ Stay with Scripture. Read a short psalm daily.
- ☐ Reach out. Tell a friend or pastor.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "God has abandoned me": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	Signs of presence
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~God has abandoned me.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, I feel abandoned. Draw near, hold my hand, and let me know You are here. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.